

Since its launch, the Hyundai Creta has had to deal with the compact Ford EcoSport, the burly eight-seater Tata Hexa, and a stunning surprise package in the Jeep Compass. The segment itself is quite vast, being among one of the highest selling in India after the ultra-affordable compact hatchbacks.

Naturally, expectations were quite high when the 2018 Hyundai Creta was unveiled. On the face of it, there are not too many changes - the front grille has been upgraded, the new skid plates add a touch of durability, and has the Swachh Can inside - an in-car dustbin that the Korean car giant very notably flew brand ambassador Shah Rukh Khan in to unveil at the 2018 Auto Expo. While it does tidy things up a bit (excuse the pun), how do all these changes reflect with the car itself?

TECHNOLOGY AND ELECTRONICS

Beginning the Hyundai Creta's technology package is the 8-inch touchscreen infotainment system running on Hyundai's proprietary infotainment firmware. As always, the system is fairly smooth, although many may feel that Hyundai could have added a bit more of a premium touch to it.

The infotainment system offers integrated navigation with voice read-out, Apple CarPlay, Android Auto and Arkamys sound modes to improve the performance of the default speakers. The firmware is the same as we have seen in every Hyundai car, and the list of features is exactly the same as what Hyundai provides in the Elantra and the new Verna. Using the system is fairly easy, with clearly marked features.

Touch response is fairly fluid, although swiping around the map shows a slight amount of stutters. The display also supports splitscreen mode, which allows you to see the map and still have access to music controls at the same time. The colour scheme is not the most interesting, though. It is functional, but not the most engaging per se. That said, the native system itself is more than good enough for every function, and that reduces Android Auto and Apple CarPlay to optional elements that you can avoid using, unless you need access to things like instant messaging services, the Google Assistant etc.

In the instrument cluster, while the backlit LED behind the analogue dials look decent, we hope that next gen vehicles have digital instrument clusters.

HYUNDAI CRETA TECHNOLOGY, DRIVE REVIEW:

A BRIGHT SPLASH OF ORANGE

The new, improved Hyundai Creta is not a full generation upgrade over its predecessor, but like every good mid-life upgrades, improves subtly over an already-established car.

Souvik Das | souvik@digit.in

